I would not say there is significantly less interest. Overall, the CAT-taking population has decreased, and this has much to do with an overall shift from management towards technology.

We have already responded by introducing an MBA in business analytics and AI, which has drawn a great deal of interest. Many technically inclined candidates are now seeking an MBA that combines people management, financial management and leadership training with a strong grounding in technology, and are gravitating toward such techno-oriented or AI-oriented MBA programmes rather than a conventional one. So, the earlier mad rush towards MBA education is easing, while those genuinely inclined towards and suited to management education remain in the pool.



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You spoke about the relevance of management education. Is the MBA relevant, and will it continue to be so?

The MBA will always be relevant, though its content will keep changing. Compare the content of an MBA in the 1970s with one from 2000-2010, or with today's—they are vastly different. Earlier curricula were dominated by manufacturing, distribution and logistics in a traditional sense. With the arrival of e-commerce, the business environment absorbed it, incorporating data and technologies such as RFID into supply chains, and a great deal of technology became embedded in MBA education. Without much fanfare, the post-2000 MBA reinvented itself.

Today, we must plan for leadership in an AI-enabled environment, and today's MBA curriculum has to adapt and shift its focus accordingly. This transformation is somewhat steeper than the previous one, because in the earlier shift, information was abundant and a good manager's skill lay in extracting knowledge from it. Today, knowledge itself is becoming abundant, so the managerial capability that matters most is judgement.

So, MBA education must shift from being about acquiring knowl-